

Week 11 — Mock Interview: Self-Reflection

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My strongest moment was explaining the KEMSA project — walking through the stockout forecasting and risk-scoring logic, because I built it and know the real numbers behind it cold, not just the concept in the abstract. I struggled more on the behavioral questions. I know my stories, like the FlowGuard pivot after realizing truck rerouting between depots wasn't actually viable, but structuring them cleanly as Situation, Task, Action, Result on the spot, without drifting into technical detail, was harder than I expected. I noticed I default to explaining the engineering before establishing the business context, which risks losing a non-technical interviewer early in the answer. My pacing also sped up under pressure, which made a couple of answers feel rushed rather than confident. Going forward, the one thing I'd change is rehearsing my STAR answers out loud beforehand rather than just knowing the story in my head — the content is there, the delivery needs tightening, especially the opening line of each answer and slowing down before the technical part. This matters because interviews for the operational-analytics roles I'm targeting weigh clear communication as much as technical depth, and I don't want strong project work getting buried under a messy or overly technical explanation.